

The Noble Vidyā Mantra Called the Purification of the Eyes

Ārya Cakṣur Viśodhani Nāma Vidyāmantra · Toh 619 · Derge Kangyur

འཕགས་པ་མགོ་རྒྱ་པར་སྟོབ་ཞེས་བརྒྱའི་འགྲེམ་སྒྲས་

Toh 619 in the Kangyur is a vidyā mantra text known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Cakṣur Viśodhani Nāma Vidyāmantra and in Tibetan as the Phakpa Mik Nampar Jongwa Shyejawé Rik Ngak, rendered into English as the Noble Vidyā Mantra Called the Purification of the Eyes. It belongs to the category of dhāraṇī and mantra literature within the Kangyur, a class of texts that combine narrative framing with sacred formulas believed to confer specific spiritual and practical benefits. This text concerns the purification and healing of the eyes, set against the backdrop of a devout layman named Śākya Deva who encounters the Buddha's teaching while residing among the Śākya community. Like many dhāraṇī texts in the Kangyur, it opens with a conventional sūtra formula establishing the presence of the Buddha and a faithful disciple, serving as the occasion for the transmission of a potent mantra.

Thus it is complete.

In the language of India: Ārya Cakṣur Viśodhani Nāma Vidyāmantra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Vidyā Mantra Called the Purification of the Eyes.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One was dwelling in a fine Śākyan village among the Śākyas. At that time, in a place called Stadusa, there lived a man named Śākya Deva who had sincere faith in the Buddha, sincere faith in the Dharma and the Saṅgha, who had gone for refuge to the Buddha, gone for refuge to the Dharma, gone for refuge to the Saṅgha, who was devoted exclusively to the Buddha, devoted exclusively to the Dharma, devoted exclusively to the Saṅgha, who had no wavering and no doubt regarding the Buddha, no wavering and no doubt regarding the Dharma, the Saṅgha, suffering, the origin of suffering, cessation, and the path, who had seen the truth, attained the fruit, and arrived at direct realization. This man, who had set aside weapons and cudgels, found that both visible and invisible forms had ceased to appear to his eyes. He then gave rise to faith in the Blessed One the Buddha, called him to mind, and paid homage to the Blessed One the Buddha, saying:

Homage to the Blessed One, the Buddha who creates light, who holds the torch, who holds radiance. O Sugata, possessed of great compassion, please illuminate clearly. O Blessed One, please purify my eyes.

When he had spoken these words, the Blessed One, who was dwelling in a divine abode, heard Śākya Deva's utterance of those words through his perfectly pure divine hearing that surpasses that of humans. Having heard them, he arose from that meditative absorption and spoke to the venerable Ānanda:

Ānanda, go and with this noble vidyā mantra of eye purification, protect Śākya Deva. Guard him completely, shelter him completely, sustain him completely. Bring about peace, well-being, the removal of punishment, the removal of weapons, the neutralization of poison, the destruction of poison, the cutting off of boundaries, and the binding of the ground. In the same way, purify the eyes of the fourfold assembly — monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen — and the eyes of other sentient beings as well. Purify the orbs of the eyes. Make the eyes free of faults.

Thus: hili mili, kili mili, hili te mili, huyā huyā huyā maṇi, hulu hulu hulu, hudu hudu hudu, cakṣur me viśodhaya svāhā.

Ānanda, this queen of vidyā mantras — the Purification of the Eyes — dispels faults of the eyes, faults of wind, faults of bile, faults of phlegm, and faults arising from their combination. By the truth of moral discipline, by the truth of ascetic practice, by the truth of the sages, by the truth of dependent origination, by the truth of suffering, by the truth of the origin of suffering, by the truth of cessation, by the truth of the path, by the truth of the arhats, by the truth of the solitary buddhas, and by the truth of the Blessed One buddhas — may there be no disease in the eyes of Śākya Deva. May there be no flow of tears. May there be no continuous flow of tears. May the eyes of myself and all sentient beings be completely purified. Svāhā.

Ānanda, this queen of vidyā mantras, the Purification of the Eyes, was spoken by six perfectly and completely awakened buddhas. I too now expound it. The four great kings, Śakra (Indra) the lord of the gods, and...

and Brahmā, the lord of the Sahā world, also rejoiced.

Ānanda, whoever recites this vidyā mantra at the three times of day will not become afflicted with cloudiness of vision, or with dimness of sight, or with cataracts, or with the blue eye-disease, or with faults of the visual faculty

arising from gods, or from nāgas, or from gandharvas, or from yakṣas, or from rākṣasas, or from flesh-eaters, or from those arising from sorcery, or from zombies, or from those arising from both zombies and sorcery, or from wandering spirits, or from those arising from both wandering spirits and zombies — that such a one should be afflicted by any of these I have not seen anywhere in this world of beings, together with its gods, its māras, its Brahmās, its ascetics and brahmins, its gods, humans, and asuras. There is no such case.

The venerable Ānanda listened respectfully to the Blessed One, and said to the Blessed One, "So be it," and took up the bases of the secret mantras, and having mastered them completely, went to where Śākya Deva was and spoke to him at length thus: "The Tathāgata has sent you these bases of the secret mantras for the purification of the eyes. Receive them, and each day recite them at the three times."

The moment Śākya Deva heard this, his eyes were completely purified. With eyes completely purified, he saw all things with stainless eyes.

The Blessed One having thus spoken, the venerable Ānanda, Śākya Deva, and the world together with its gods rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had said.

The noble Purification of the Eyes

Translator's Notes

• The place name "stadusa" (Stadusa) is unidentified; it may be a phonetic rendering of an Indian toponym not securely identified in the literature, and the spelling here is tentative.

The name "śākya deva" is rendered "Śākya Deva" — the second element "deva" literally means "happiness/bliss" but functions here as part of a proper name; it could also be understood as "Śākya Sukha," though "Śākya Deva" is a conventional reading.

The text breaks off mid-sentence, as the passage supplied ends with an incomplete enumeration.

• The term rendered "gandharvas" translates the Tibetan for "scent-eaters" (dri za), a standard class of semi-divine beings. "Zombies" renders ro langs, literally "risen corpses," a class of animated corpse-spirits in the Indic and Tibetan demonological tradition; the term "zombie" is a loose but functional equivalent for a listening audience. "Wandering spirits" renders kun tu rgyu, literally "all-pervasive wanderers," a class of malevolent roaming spirits. "Flesh-eaters" renders sha za, corresponding to Sanskrit piśāca. "Those arising from sorcery" renders byad las gyur pa, referring to afflictions caused by ritual cursing or harmful spells. The final line "The noble Purification of the Eyes" is a colophon title and represents the end of the text.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.